

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 908

By Harris

A RESOLUTION to commemorate March 4, 2026, as HPV Awareness Day in Tennessee.

WHEREAS, human papillomavirus (HPV), a common virus that affects nearly everyone, can lead to six types of cancer; nearly every U.S. citizen will contract the virus at some point in his or her life; and

WHEREAS, oropharyngeal and cervical cancers are the two most prevalent HPV-associated cancers in the U.S.; and

WHEREAS, the incidence rates of oropharyngeal and cervical cancers and of HPV cancers overall are higher in Tennessee than the national averages; and

WHEREAS, a safe, highly effective, and long-lasting vaccination against HPV has been recommended in the U.S. since 2006; this vaccination protects against ninety percent of HPV cancers and is widely available; and

WHEREAS, HPV vaccination is recommended for all people nine to twenty-six years of age and for some people twenty-seven to forty-five years of age who were not vaccinated as children; and

WHEREAS, on-time HPV vaccination is routinely recommended at ages nine to twelve years for optimal protection against HPV cancers as an adult; and

WHEREAS, while Tennessee has steadily increased the percentage of citizens having received routinely recommended HPV vaccination, HPV vaccination coverage statewide continues to lag; and

WHEREAS, the HPV Cancer Prevention Program of St. Jude Children's Research Hospital is focused on galvanizing existing successful HPV cancer prevention efforts and introducing new ones in support of increasing HPV vaccination and reducing HPV cancer cases

and deaths across Memphis, the State of Tennessee, the Southeastern U.S., and nationally;
and

WHEREAS, to that end, the St. Jude HPV Cancer Prevention Program has formed the HPV Vaccination Roundtable of the Southeast, which is inclusive of Tennessee medical and public health professionals, to address low HPV vaccination coverage and high rates of HPV cancers; and

WHEREAS, the international HPV Awareness Day campaign, Ask about HPV, is a key initiative of the International Papillomavirus Society and its partners, including St. Jude Children's Research Hospital; and

WHEREAS, this campaign aims to increase public awareness of the virus as part of its mission to improve understanding of HPV and the importance of prevention, screening, diagnosis, and treatment of papillomavirus-related diseases; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that March 4, 2026, is commemorated as HPV Awareness Day in Tennessee to raise public awareness about HPV vaccinations and other HPV cancer prevention measures.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.